

Welcome

I am a senior lecturer at the School of Business (of the University of Wollongong) and very passionate about delivering excellent research and impactful outcomes by acquiring valuable knowledge of how firms (or economies) work and applying this knowledge to make our community better.

I obtained my PhD in Economics from the University of Adelaide in 2014 and my research focus is data envelopment analysis and stochastic frontier analysis. I have developed a strong track record of research in productivity and efficiency analysis, and its application to pressing problems such as healthcare efficiency and sustainable economic growth. My CV is available on request and you might find more information on my research via my Google Scholar profile and Scopus profile. Mentions of my research in peer-reviewed papers are also summarised using my scite Dashboard.

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1 Membership

HEA fellowship (Higher Education Academy) and ISEaPA membership (International Society for Efficiency and Productivity Analysis)

2 Working Paper

Du, K., Prokhorov, A. and Tran, K.C. (2025). Spatial Stochastic Frontier Model with Latent Classes

Du, K. (2024). Promoting Green Technical Efficiency: A Regional and Urban Agglomeration Cluster Analysis (PDF). Supplemental Materials (PDF)

Wang, Y., Du, K. and O'Connor, A. (2018). Diversity in Entrepreneurship: Why it Matters for Public Policy, Trade Dynamics and Economic Growth. (Corresponding author)

3 Journal Articles

1. Du, K. and Zelenyuk, V. (2024). Likelihood-Ratio Test for Technological Differences in Two-Stage Data Envelopment Analysis for Panel Data, *European Journal of Operational Research*, 321(2): 644–663. (Corresponding author, ABDC A*)
2. Mahadevan, R., Du, K., Preciados, L. and Schmidt, S. (2022). Managing Nitrogen Environmental Impacts to Improve Green Technical Efficiency in Philippines Rice Cultivation, *Journal of Environmental Management*, DOI: 10.1016/j.jenvman.2022.116529. (Corresponding author, ABDC A)
3. Peng, Q.N., Du, K., and Wang, C. (2022). How Mitigation Efforts Moderate the Impact of Climate Change on Agricultural Efficiency: A Preliminary Analysis from China, *Applied Economics Letters*, DOI: 10.1080/13504851.2022.2124227. (ABDC B)
4. Du, K. and O'Connor, A. (2019). Examining Economic Complexity as a Holistic Innovation System Effect, *Small Business Economics*, DOI: 10.1007/s11187-019-00215-z (Corresponding author, ABDC A)
5. Du, K., Worthington, A.C. and Zelenyuk, V. (2018). Data envelopment analysis, truncated regression and double-bootstrap for panel data with application to Chinese banking, *European Journal of Operational Research*, 265: 748–64, DOI: 10.1016/j.ejor.2017.08.005 (Corresponding author, ABDC A*)
6. Du, K. and O'Connor, A. (2018). Entrepreneurship and Advancing National Level Economic Efficiency, *Small Business Economics*, 50: 91–111, DOI: 10.1007/s11187-017-9904-4 (Corresponding author, ABDC A)
7. Du, K. and Sim, N. (2016). Emerging Countries, Mergers and Acquisitions, Bank Efficiency, *Research in International Business and Finance*, 36: 499–510, DOI: 10.1016/j.ribaf.2015.10.005 (ABDC B)

8. O'Connor, A., Du, K. and Roos, G. (2015). The Intellectual Capital Needs of A Transitioning Economy, *Journal of Intellectual Capital*, 16(3): 466–489, DOI: 10.1108/JIC-08-2014-0097 (Corresponding author, ABDC B)

Note: Ranking of Australian Business Deans Council (ABDC) is a ranking of journal quality (2013 version), in which A* means an academic journal in the top 6.9% (A: top 20.8% and B: top 28.4%) of 2,767 journals.

4 Book Chapter

Du, K. (2016). Did Efficiency of Chinese Commercial Banks Increase after WTO Accession? Bias Corrected Analysis from 2000 to 2009, Chapter 6 in Andressen, C.A. (ed.) *China's Changing Economy: Trends, Impacts and the Future*, Routledge.

5 Recent Teaching

I introduce students with a basic grounding in economic statistics to how empirical researchers think about and apply econometric methods with a practical approach (from 2020). This is a link to my teaching philosophy and the course profiles.

University of Wollongong

ECON940 (*Business Statistics*) 2025 Trimester 1, 2 and 3; ECON910 (*Economics for Professionals*) 2025 Trimester 3; ECON361 (*Explorations in Microeconomics*) 2025 Autumn Semester.

ECON802 (*Economics of Global Business Challenges*) 2024 Trimester 1; ECON102 (*Economics and Society*) 2024 Spring Semester; ECON910 (*Economics for Professionals*) 2024 Trimester 2.

ECON910 (*Economics for Professionals*) 2023 Trimester 1 and 3; ECON102 (*Economics and Society*) 2023 Autumn Semester.

University of Queensland

ECON7310 (*Elements of Econometrics*) 2021 Semester 1; ECON7310 (*Elements of Econometrics*) 2020 Semester 1 Lesson Plan (Draft).

6 Grant and Awards

2025 UOW Staff Internal Research Fund (\$3,000 from UOW BAL Faculty)
2024 UOW Staff Internal Research Fund (\$3,000 from UOW BAL Faculty)
2023 UOW Staff Internal Research Fund (\$3,000 from UOW BAL Faculty)
2021 UQ Staff Research Fund (\$4,000 from the School of Economics)
2020 ASSA-CASS Joint Action Program (\$7,700 from Academy of the Social Sciences in Australia with A/Prof. Renuka Mahadevan)
2019 UQ New Staff Research Start-Up Fund (\$5,000 from UQ BEL Faculty)
2018 UQ Development Fellow of the University of Queensland
2017 Vice-Chancellor's Postdoctoral Fellow of RMIT University
2013 Write-Up Fund for young researchers (to cover half a year's accommodation), University of Adelaide
2009 PhD scholarship, University of Adelaide

7 Referee Service

European Journal of Operational Research; Journal of Productivity Analysis; Annals of Operations Research; Pacific-Basin Finance Journal; Economic Modelling; International Review of Economics & Finance as well as Emerging Markets Finance and Trade